❻ Mock parsing function

And with that, the application is complete. You have learned how to build an app hierarchically, from the app to the worker, via the guardian and the manager. You also learned how to spawn actors and create adapters.

The next section deals with a different type of request/response. It is called `ask`, and it is a request that expects a response.

3.2 Asking and expecting a reply

In Akka, to *ask* means to send a message that includes a callback within a certain time. When an actor asks, two things can happen: it either receives a response indicating that the message has been processed or receives no response. If it doesn't get a response after waiting a certain amount of time, the actor has to decide what to do. This is the same as many other types of communication, such as sending an email. If you need an answer and don't get it, how long are you willing to wait before you take action?

In Akka, the answer is formulated in terms of time and two possible outcomes. When you ask for something, you have to specify how long you are willing to wait; to do so, you use the `Timeout` class. Because you may or may not receive a response, you check the two options: `Success` and `Failure`. These two options form the class `Try[T]`, where `T` is the type of the actor being asked, which you receive on a successful answer. Otherwise, `T` does not apply—if the actor does not answer, there is a failure, which does not have type `T`.